11-19 第一篇

The Benefits of Bilingualism: Speaking More Than One Language

More than half of the world's population speaks at least two languages. Being bilingual—able to use two languages—is common in many countries and is becoming more valued everywhere. Children who grow up with two languages often switch between them naturally at home, at school, or with friends. Learning a second language is not only useful for travel and work; it also brings benefits for the mind. [1] Bilingualism opens doors to new cultures, job opportunities, and a broader view of the world, while also strengthening the brain in surprising ways.

Research has shown that bilingual people often have certain cognitive advantages. They tend to be better at focusing their attention and ignoring distractions. When you speak two languages, your brain constantly chooses which language to use and which to hold back. This "mental exercise" can improve skills like problem-solving and multitasking. Some studies even suggest that bilingualism may help delay memory decline in older adults. [2] In short, using two languages regularly gives the brain a workout that can improve mental flexibility and control.

Bilingualism also affects the way we see the world. Different languages often express ideas in different ways. For example, some languages have many words for colors or family relationships that others do not. Speaking more than one language can make people more aware of different perspectives and help them understand that there is more than one way to think about things. [3] This openness to different viewpoints can make bilingual people more creative and better at understanding others.

Of course, learning a second language takes time and effort. Young children often pick up languages more easily, but older learners can still succeed with practice and patience. Immersion—spending time in a place where the language is spoken—can speed up learning. So can reading, watching films, or talking with native speakers online. [4] With the right methods and enough practice, most people can achieve a useful level of fluency in a second language.

In our connected world, bilingualism is more valuable than ever. Companies look for employees who can communicate with international clients. Schools encourage students to learn foreign languages from an early age. Families who speak more than one language pass on both their words and their traditions. [5] Whether we learn a second language as children or as adults, bilingualism enriches our lives and helps us connect with a wider, more diverse world.

选项

A. Bilingualism opens doors to new cultures, job opportunities, and a broader view of the world, while also strengthening the brain in surprising ways. B. In short, using two languages regularly gives the brain a workout that can improve mental flexibility and control. C. This openness to different viewpoints can make bilingual people more creative and better at understanding others. D. With the right methods and enough practice, most people can achieve a useful level of fluency in a second language. E. Whether we learn a second language as children or as adults, bilingualism enriches our lives and helps us connect with a wider, more diverse world. F. For example, in Switzerland, many people speak German, French, and Italian because the country has regions where each language is used daily.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：空前介绍双语现象——全球过半人口、儿童自然切换、旅行工作实用，空后需升华双语的多重价值。A的"opens doors to new cultures, job opportunities, and a broader view"与前文实用与认知内容对应，"strengthening the brain in surprising ways"引出下段认知优势。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：空前列举双语者的认知优势——注意力、抗干扰、语言切换练习、problem-solving、可能延缓记忆衰退，空后需总结大脑锻炼效果。B的"In short"提示总结，"gives the brain a workout"与前文 mental exercise 呼应，"mental flexibility and control"概括认知益处。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：空前说明语言影响思维——不同语言表达差异、更多视角意识，空后需总结这种开放心态的影响。C的"This openness to different viewpoints"与前文"different perspectives"对应，"more creative and better at understanding others"概括双语带来的思维与社交优势。
- **[4] D**：
  - **线索**：空前指出学习二语的困难及应对——儿童易学、成人可通过沉浸、阅读、影视、交流等提高，空后需总结学习可行性。D的"With the right methods and enough practice"承接前文方法建议，"most people can achieve a useful level of fluency"给出积极结论。

- [5] E：
    - **线索**：空前描述双语在当代的价值——企业、学校、家庭传承，空后需收束全文。E的"Whether we learn... as children or as adults"呼应前文不同年龄学习，"enriches our lives and helps us connect with a wider, more diverse world"是全文主题的升华。
- **干扰项分析**：
    - **F. For example, in Switzerland, many people speak German, French, and Italian because the country has regions where each language is used daily.**：以For example开头，为具体国家多语案例（瑞士）。各空均为概括或过渡句；[1]易被误选因涉及多语现象，但该空需总结双语的多重价值，而非某一国家的语言分布情况。